Migrate from VMware NSX to Cisco Secure Workload

Hypervisor-independent microsegmentation — one policy model for every workload: bare metal, VM, container, and cloud.

CISCO
Secure Workload

VMware NSX DFW
enforced in the ESXi kernel · VMware only → **Cisco Secure Workload**
enforced in the workload OS · any platform

WHY MOVE NOW

- **Licensing & cost** — re-evaluate spend after Broadcom/VMware packaging changes.
- **No platform lock-in** — enforcement leaves the hypervisor for the workload OS.
- **Multicloud, one model** — on-prem, AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes.
- **Discovery, not guesswork** — ADM auto-builds policy from real flow + process data.

THE SHIFT

- A lightweight **CSW agent** enforces per host (Linux iptables/ipset, Windows WFP).
- Cloud workloads can be **agentless** (AWS SG / Azure NSG / GCP FW).
- Rich **flow + process visibility** feeds automatic policy discovery.

PLAN FOR THESE DELTAS

- **L7 App-ID (DPI)** → process + FQDN policy; true L7 via Secure Firewall / Hypershield.
- **Distributed IDS/IPS** → Cisco Secure Firewall (CSW adds forensics & vuln context).
- **Identity Firewall (AD user)** → Cisco ISE user/device context.

WHAT MAPS CLEANLY

VMware NSX	Cisco Secure Workload
Tags / VM attributes	**Labels (vCenter, CMDB, ServiceNow)**
Groups (dynamic/static)	**Inventory filters + Scopes**
Security Policy / Category	**Workspace + policy priority**
DFW rule (src/dst/svc)	**Policy (consumer→provider)**
Services (ports/proto)	**Protocols & ports**
Applied To	**Scope assignment**

HOW WE DE-RISK IT — 7 PHASES

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Discover	Model	Translate	Analyze	Parallel	Cutover	Retire

- NSX keeps enforcing until each app's CSW policy is **proven in live analysis**.
- Cut over **one application at a time**, then retire the matching NSX rules.
- Rollback is always "disable CSW enforcement on that scope."

> **Golden rule:** never enforce the same application on NSX and CSW at the same time.

OUTCOME

Portable, **zero-trust microsegmentation** across your entire estate — with lower platform dependency and richer visibility — delivered through a **controlled, reversible, per-application cutover**. No automated rule import is required: CSW's ADM proposes policy from your real traffic, so you validate intent instead of hand-copying thousands of rules.